

THE KIND OF DATA THAT IS TARGETED

PERSONALLY IDENTIFIABLE INFORMATION

Of patients and healthcare workers, such as name, address, email, phone number, gender

OTHER RECORDS

Pertaining to blood donors, ambulances, vaccinations, caregivers and login credentials

WHAT HAPPENS TO COMPROMISED DATA

HELD TO RANSOM

The ransomware attackers demand money (usually crypto) for restoring the stolen data. In the AIIMS case, reports suggest, hackers have sought Rs 200 crore, though there has been no official confirmation

DARK WEB DUMPS

Stolen data is typically leaked or sold on the Darknet—internet sites that are not indexed. In November, hackers who breached health data involving 9.7 million people from Australian insurer Medibank began leaking it on the dark web

HOW TO PROTECT DATA

UP-TO-DATE FIREWALLS

Securing all devices on a network with a firewall, regularly updating software and patching vulnerabilities

DATA BACK-UPs

Both on the cloud and offline

PHISHING SIMULATION

A mock drill that organisations can carry out by sending out phishing mails to employees

HOW ATTACKS TAKE PLACE

PHISHING

Via fraudulent emails with malicious links embedded in them

EXPLOIT

A piece of code that looks for vulnerability in an application or computer system through which malware can be injected

ANATOMY OF A RANSOMWARE ATTACK

1. Attacker sends a phishing email

2. User receives a link and clicks; malware executes

3. Attacker gains control of the 'public key' required to encrypt files

4. Files get encrypted and user gets ransomware screen

5. Attacker demands ransom (mostly crypto) from the user

6. When ransom is paid, attacker may deliver the 'private (decryption) key'*

**Source: United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime; it recommends against paying ransom, and suggests preventive measures to reduce the risk instead*